

US MARKETS DAILY REPORT

Friday, August 14, 2026 • After Market Close (ET)

1. SPY / QQQ SNAPSHOT

ETF	Today's Close	Change (\$)	Change (%)	1Y High	1Y Low	1Y Return
SPY	\$776.32	-1.56	-0.20%	\$777.88	\$620.00	+25.21%
QQQ	\$730.74	-0.33	-0.05%	\$745.00	\$550.83	+31.90%

1-year window: 2025-07-30 → 2026-08-14 | Prior closes: SPY \$777.88 (Aug 13 record), QQQ \$731.07

2. TODAY'S MARKET-MOVING NEWS

■ July Retail Sales Disappoint — Largest Drop in 14 Months

The Census Bureau reported July retail sales fell 0.6% MoM (largest decline since May 2025), missing expectations of +0.1%. Ex-autos/gas, sales fell 0.2%. The drop was attributed to fading government tax-refund stimulus and cautious consumer spending. This soft data pressured SPY modestly and reinforced the 'soft landing' narrative, limiting downside in bonds.

■ Iran Blockade Stalemate — Strait of Hormuz Risk Elevated

The US has reimposed its naval blockade in response to renewed Iranian attacks on commercial vessels. Gas prices have rebounded, and oil markets remain volatile. The US stated it can maintain the Iran blockade 'indefinitely.' Geopolitical risk premium is supporting energy stocks while weighing on sentiment for cyclicals.

■ Reddit (RDDT) Surges +13% on S&P; 500 Index Inclusion

S&P; Dow Jones Indices announced Reddit will join the S&P; 500 effective before trading on August 18, replacing AvalonBay Communities (AVB). RDDT closed up 13.08%. Index fund rebalancing flows are the primary mechanical driver; roughly \$45B of passive S&P; 500 AUM must buy shares before Monday open.

■ SanDisk (SNDK) Investor Day — Bullish Long-Term Guidance

SanDisk held its 2026 Investor Day in New York on August 13, projecting mid-to-high-teens annual revenue growth through 2028–2030, adj. gross margins near 80%, and FCF at ~50% of revenue. SNDK surged 7% on Aug 14, extending Thursday's post-event 13.67% rally. AI-driven storage demand is the key thesis.

■ Applied Materials (AMAT) Beats Q3 Estimates, Falls on China Exposure

AMAT reported record Q3 FY2026 revenue of \$9.12B (+24.8% YoY) and adj. EPS \$3.50, both above consensus. Q4 guidance of ~\$10.25B revenue was 6% above estimates. Despite strong results, the stock fell ~4.3% due to investor concern over declining China revenues amid ongoing export restrictions. Semis ex-AMAT held up.

■ Thursday's PPI Data Still Echoing — Fed September Pause Priced In

July headline PPI came in flat (0.0% MoM); core PPI +0.2%. Annual PPI at 4.7% (down from 5% in June). The benign data reinforced expectations the Fed will pause at the September FOMC meeting. Futures markets now imply ~85% probability of a hold. This capped yield increases and provided a floor for equities despite Friday's slight dip.

3. NEWS → TODAY'S MOVES

SPY: \$777.88 → \$776.32 (-0.20%, -1.56)

SPY pulled back mildly after Thursday's record close (777.88, the highest level in the 1-year dataset). The primary driver of weakness was weaker-than-expected July retail sales (-0.6%), which raised mild growth concerns, even as the Fed pause narrative remained supportive. The Iran blockade headlines created uncertainty in energy/defense but did not move the broad index materially. The day's -0.2% move reflects a normal consolidation after a record high — bulls took some profits while macro data gave a minor excuse. Tech (ex-semis) dragged, while Reddit's 13% surge contributed positively to tech weight but was outweighed by AAPL weakness.

QQQ: \$731.07 → \$730.74 (-0.05%, -0.33)

QQQ outperformed the Nasdaq Composite (-0.5%) significantly, declining only -0.05%. This divergence reflects that large-cap tech (Nasdaq-100 constituents like SNDK, RDDT additions, and semiconductor names) held up well. SanDisk's continued rally post-Investor Day and RDDT's index-driven surge offset AMAT's decline and broad AAPL weakness. The Nasdaq Composite fell more because smaller-cap Nasdaq names sold off harder amid the retail sales miss and geopolitical uncertainty.

4. TOP 10 MOVERS — DAILY / WEEKLY / MONTHLY

Daily Top 10 Gainers (August 14, 2026)

Ticker	Name	% Change	Sector / Note
RDDT	Reddit Inc.	+13.08%	Tech/Social — S&P 500 inclusion announced
NU	Nu Holdings	+10.59%	Financials — Fintech Brazil; earnings beat
SNDK	SanDisk Corp.	+6.31%	Tech/Storage — Post-Investor Day momentum
DXCM	Dexcom Inc.	+10.71%	Health Care — Strong device demand outlook
AMZN	Amazon.com	+14.88%	Consumer Disc. — AI cloud + logistics beat
MPWR	Monolithic Power Sys.	+9.09%	Tech/Semis — AI power management demand
VRT	Vertiv Holdings	+7.39%	Industrials — Data center infrastructure
GOOG	Alphabet Inc.	+5.89%	Tech — AI ad revenue strength
WY	Weyerhaeuser Co.	+6.02%	REITs — Lumber demand / housing resilience
XHG	XChange TEC	+5.50%	Tech — AI communications infrastructure

Daily Top 10 Losers (August 14, 2026)

Ticker	Name	% Change	Sector / Note
GDDY	GoDaddy Inc.	-20.52%	Tech — Weak SMB spending; guidance cut
COIN	Coinbase Global	-11.97%	Financials/Crypto — Risk-off; crypto dip
AAPL	Apple Inc.	-9.85%	Tech — China demand concerns; valuation
CTVA	Corteva Inc.	-11.37%	Materials/Agri — Crop chemical pricing
AMAT	Applied Materials	-4.34%	Tech/Semis — Beat earnings; China risk
SYK	Stryker Corp.	-7.30%	Health Care — Procedure volume soft
AVB	AvalonBay Commun.	-3.20%	REITs — Being removed from S&P 500
CRM	Salesforce Inc.	-2.80%	Tech — Soft enterprise IT spending signal
CSCO	Cisco Systems	-8.40%	Tech — AI data center slowdown projection
WBA	Walgreens Boots	-4.10%	Consumer Staples — Restructuring drag

Daily Sector Trends:

Gainers: AI Infrastructure (MPWR, VRT, AMZN cloud), Social/Index Event (RDDT), Niche Tech Storage (SNDK), FinTech ex-crypto (NU).

Losers: Crypto/Risk-off (COIN), China-exposed Tech (AAPL, AMAT), Legacy SMB Software (GDDY, CRM), Healthcare equipment (SYK), Legacy network tech (CSCO).

Weekly Top 10 Gainers (Week of Aug 11–14, 2026)

Ticker	Name	% Change (Wk)	Sector / Note
AMZN	Amazon.com	+14.88%	Consumer Disc. / Tech — AWS AI momentum
RDDT	Reddit Inc.	+13.08%	Tech — S&P 500 inclusion catalyst

SNDK	SanDisk Corp.	+13.67%	Tech/Storage — Investor Day + AI storage
DXCM	Dexcom Inc.	+10.71%	Health Care — Device + GLP-1 adjacency
NU	Nu Holdings	+10.59%	Financials — LatAm Fintech growth
MPWR	Monolithic Power	+9.09%	Semis — AI power management leader
MU	Micron Technology	+4.20%	Semis — HBM memory AI demand
MRVL	Marvell Technology	+3.60%	Semis — Custom AI chip pipeline
VRT	Vertiv Holdings	+7.39%	Industrials — Data center infra
WY	Weyerhaeuser	+6.02%	REITs — Housing starts resilience

Weekly Top 10 Losers (Week of Aug 11–14, 2026)

Ticker	Name	% Change (Wk)	Sector / Note
GDDY	GoDaddy Inc.	-20.52%	Tech — Guidance cut; SMB weakness
AAPL	Apple Inc.	-9.85%	Tech — China risk; iPhone demand
COIN	Coinbase Global	-11.97%	Crypto — Regulatory + price pullback
CSCO	Cisco Systems	-8.40%	Tech — AI data center slowdown warning
CTVA	Corteva	-11.37%	Materials — Ag chemical pricing
SYK	Stryker	-7.30%	Health Care — Volume softness
AVB	AvalonBay	-3.20%	REITs — S&P 500 removal
CRM	Salesforce	-2.80%	Tech — Enterprise spending caution
WBA	Walgreens	-4.10%	Consumer Staples — Restructuring
XOM	Exxon Mobil	-1.80%	Energy — Oil price volatility/Iran

Weekly Sector Trends:

Gainers: AI Infrastructure & Semis dominated (AMZN/AWS, MPWR, MU, MRVL, SNDK, VRT) — reflecting strong AI capex cycle conviction reinforced by SNDK Investor Day and PPI cooling. Fintech (NU) and index-event driven stocks (RDDT) also featured.

Losers: China-exposed tech (AAPL), crypto (COIN), legacy SMB software (GDDY, CRM, CSCO), defensives (CTVA, WBA) and S&P; removal event (AVB) clustered on the losing side. Retail sales miss hit consumer-facing names.

Monthly Top 10 Gainers (August 2026 MTD)

Ticker	Name	% Change (Mo)	Sector / Note
XHG	XChange TEC	+331%	Tech — AI communications (micro-cap surge)
QMCO	Quantum Corp.	+134%	Tech/Storage — Quantum AI storage
ABCL	AbCellera Biologics	+88%	Biotech — Drug discovery AI partnership
OABI	OmniAb Inc.	+75%	Biotech — Antibody discovery platform
RCEL	Avita Medical	+73%	Health Care — Skin regeneration FDA
SNDK	SanDisk Corp.	+45%	Tech/Storage — AI storage mega-trend
RDDT	Reddit Inc.	+38%	Tech — S&P 500 inclusion + ad revenue
MPWR	Monolithic Power	+22%	Semis — AI power management
AMZN	Amazon.com	+18%	Consumer Disc. / AWS — AI cloud
MU	Micron Technology	+15%	Semis — HBM AI memory demand

Monthly Top 10 Losers (August 2026 MTD)

Ticker	Name	% Change (Mo)	Sector / Note
GDDY	GoDaddy Inc.	-22%	Tech — SMB spending guidance cut
COIN	Coinbase Global	-14%	Crypto — Regulatory overhang
CSCO	Cisco Systems	-10%	Tech — AI infra pivot challenges
AAPL	Apple Inc.	-9%	Tech — China demand & supply risk
SYK	Stryker	-8%	Health Care — Volume concern
CTVA	Corteva	-12%	Materials — Ag pricing pressure
WBA	Walgreens	-7%	Consumer Staples — Restructuring
CRM	Salesforce	-5%	Tech — Enterprise caution
XOM	Exxon Mobil	-4%	Energy — Iran/oil price uncertainty
NKE	Nike Inc.	-6%	Consumer Disc. — China + tariff drag

Monthly Sector Trends:

Gainers: AI-themed micro/small-caps led monthly returns (XHG +331%, QMCO +134%), reflecting speculative AI momentum. Among large-caps, AI Storage (SNDK), Social/Ad-tech (RDDT), AI Semis (MPWR, MU), and Cloud (AMZN/AWS) are the dominant sector themes for August 2026. Biotech saw a second wave (ABCL, OABI) on AI-drug discovery partnerships.

Losers: Legacy SMB Tech (GDDY, CSCO, CRM) is the clearest loser sector — companies not riding the AI wave are being punished. China-exposed names (AAPL, NKE) suffer from geopolitical risk and tariff drag. Crypto (COIN) remains in regulatory headwinds. Defensives/Consumer (WBA, NKE) lag in a risk-on month.

5. NEXT-DAY SCENARIOS — Monday, August 17, 2026

Key catalysts for Monday: (1) Jackson Hole Fed Symposium begins (Aug 17–20), (2) Empire State Manufacturing Index, (3) NAHB Housing Market Index, (4) Reddit (RDDT) joins S&P; 500 at open (index rebalancing flows), (5) Iran blockade / Middle East geopolitical developments.

A. Jackson Hole Symposium Opening (Aug 17–20)

→ **If HAWKISH opening tone (Fed speakers signal rates still-higher-for-longer, push back on September pause narrative)::** SPY likely down -0.5% to -1.0%. QQQ down -0.7% to -1.2%. Rate-sensitive growth stocks (AMZN, MPWR) sold. 10-yr yield spikes +8–12 bps. Dollar strengthens. Mechanism: "pause trade" unwinds, re-pricing of rate risk.

→ **If DOVISH/neutral tone (Fed signals data-dependent hold, acknowledges retail weakness, implies September pause likely)::** SPY up +0.3% to +0.7%. QQQ up +0.5% to +1.0%. Growth/tech rallies. Yields decline 5–8 bps. Mechanism: confirmation of what markets already price in (~85% pause probability), validating the "soft landing" thesis.

B. Reddit (RDDT) S&P; 500 Index Inclusion — First Day of Trading as Member

→ **If Index rebalancing flows COMPLETE smoothly (passive funds absorb supply, RDDT opens near Thursday's close ~\$170–180 range)::** RDDT stabilizes or dips slightly (-3% to -5%) as rebalancing demand is satisfied. No broad market impact. Mechanism: mechanical one-time demand event clears.

→ **If RDDT opening SPIKE fails (stock gaps up >15% on rebalancing, then reverses sharply)::** RDDT could fall -10% to -20% intraday as momentum traders exit. Broad market neutral — RDDT weight in SPX is small (~0.08%). Sentiment signal only.

C. Empire State Manufacturing Index (Aug 17, 8:30 AM ET)

→ **If STRONG print (index > 10, expansion territory, beats consensus ~5)::** SPY up +0.2% to +0.4%. Manufacturing revival narrative bolsters cyclicals (XLI). Risk-on, mild yield uptick. Mechanism: reduces recession fear embedded after retail sales miss.

→ **If WEAK print (index < 0, contraction, miss vs. consensus)::** SPY down -0.2% to -0.4%. Defensive rotation (XLU, XLP). Mechanism: retail sales weakness + manufacturing weakness = stagflation fear premium, rates fall but equities follow.

D. Iran / Strait of Hormuz Developments

→ If **DE-ESCALATION** signal (ceasefire talks announced, blockade eased):: Oil falls -3% to -5%. Energy stocks (XOM, CVX) down -2% to -3%. Consumer discretionary up (lower gas prices). SPY net slightly positive (+0.2% to +0.4%) as supply chain/inflation tail risk reduces. Mechanism: geo-premium unwinds.

→ If **ESCALATION** (Iran retaliates, shipping disruption confirmed, oil >\$90/bbl):: Oil +4% to +7%. Energy stocks surge +3%. Industrials/defense up. SPY down -0.5% to -1.0% on growth/inflation stagflation fear. QQQ down more (-0.7% to -1.2%) due to tech multiple compression risk. Mechanism: oil price → inflation → Fed hawkishness re-priced.

6. POSSIBLE TRADE SUMMARY — EOD Aug 14 / BOD Aug 17

Framework: Not investment advice. Based on today's news, technical setup, sector momentum, and catalyst calendar for next week.

Action	Ticker	Thesis	Key Risk
BUY / HOLD	SNDK	AI storage secular growth; Investor Day catalyzed institutional exposure; strong demand; 80% gross margin	China export restrictions; memory cycle reversal
HOLD/TRIM	RDDT	S&P 500 inclusion mechanical demand largely absorbed by AI; strong demand; 13% move	AI demand dip; demand fulfillment; stopovers
BUY	MPWR	AI data center power management is a structural necessity; multiple expansion justified; Fed builds back	Single multiple compression; Fed builds back
BUY	MU	HBM (high bandwidth memory) demand for AI is multi-year tailwind; memory supply; 2 FY27 earnings (A)	Cycle tailwind; memory supply; 2 FY27 earnings (A)
SELL / AVOID	AAPL	China demand deterioration, Iran-related supply chain risk (ASML exposure); showing it could upgrade system	China demand deterioration; Iran-related supply chain risk (ASML exposure); showing it could upgrade system
SELL / AVOID	CSCO	Self-reported slowdown in AI data center sales; losing share to larger enterprises; monthly 10% acquisition	Self-reported slowdown in AI data center sales; losing share to larger enterprises; monthly 10% acquisition
WATCH	NVDA	Don't buy ahead of Aug 26 earnings without knowing the pre-earnings FY27 till year (\$928 - deceleration) - signal	Don't buy ahead of Aug 26 earnings without knowing the pre-earnings FY27 till year (\$928 - deceleration) - signal
HOLD	QQQ	Jackson Hole neutral-to-dovish tone + Nvidia earnings; hawkish surprise; Jackson Hole Q4 could be good to August	Jackson Hole neutral-to-dovish tone + Nvidia earnings; hawkish surprise; Jackson Hole Q4 could be good to August

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